INTERNAL SUMMARY

Ofsted Inspection Report Summary — February 2026

Inspection overview

Inspection dates	10–13 February 2026
Type	Full inspection, report-card framework
Inspection team	Lead inspector plus four Ofsted inspectors (remote and on-site with employers)
Nominee	Dr Siân Llewellyn, Director of Quality & Compliance
Report published	12 March 2026
Apprentices on programme at inspection	c. 1,350

Report card outcomes

Evaluation area	Outcome
Achievement	Strong standard
Curriculum and teaching	Strong standard
Participation and development	Strong standard
Inclusion	Strong standard
Leadership and governance	Strong standard
Safeguarding	Met

Key findings

- Inspectors judged curricula to be ambitious and highly relevant to employers' needs, particularly in AI and data, where coaches 'bring current industry practice into every session'.
- Apprentices develop substantial new knowledge, skills and behaviours and apply them at work quickly; employers gave many examples of productivity gains.
- Achievement has improved markedly and is now high; the proportion of high grades at EPA is above that of similar providers.
- Progress reviews are thorough and involve employers well, although targets are sometimes too broad.
- Safeguarding arrangements are effective. Apprentices feel safe, know how to report concerns and understand the risks of radicalisation and online harms relevant to their sectors.
- Leaders and governors have an accurate view of strengths and weaknesses; self-assessment closely matched inspection findings.

What Delcorn should do to improve

1 Ensure coaches set precise, measurable targets in every progress review so that apprentices know exactly what they need to do next.

2. Work with a minority of employers to make sure apprentices receive their full entitlement to off-the-job training.
3. Ensure that the most able apprentices are challenged early to achieve the highest grades.
4. Strengthen the way coaches revisit Prevent and British values so that apprentices' understanding is deepened over time.

Follow-up
All four recommendations were incorporated into the Quality Improvement Plan 2026/27 (QIP-04, QIP-06, QIP-05 and QIP-08).

Inspection learning for next time

- The Inspection Readiness Evidence Map made it easy to retrieve evidence during the call; keep it current monthly.
- Inspectors sampled 46 apprentices; having review records signed by all parties was essential.
- Employer interviews were the most influential evidence for curriculum judgements — maintain a bank of willing employer contacts.